UGANDA NATIONAL BUREAU OF STANDARDS (UNBS) & UGANDA REVENUE AUTHORITY (URA)
OFFICIAL STATUTORY & REGULATORY COMPENDIUM (FY 2024/25 ? FY 2026/27)

1. UNBS Public Notice to Importers: New Electronic Imports Portal (e-Portal) Integrated with URA ASYCUDA World (Effective July 2025 ? FY 2026/27)

Effective July 2025 and reinforced in September 2026, the Uganda National Bureau of Standards (UNBS) switched to the advanced web-based Imports Electronic Portal (https://eportal.unbs.go.ug) directly integrated with Uganda Revenue Authority (URA) ASYCUDA World and the Uganda Electronic Single Window (UESW).

- **Statutory Basis**: UNBS Act (Cap. 210) and the UNBS (Inspection and Clearance of Imports) Regulations, 2022.
- **Account Creation**: Importers and clearing agents register on https://eportal.unbs.go.ug using a valid URA Tax Identification Number (TIN) and email address.
- **Automated PRN & ICC Issuance**: The UNBS e-Portal automatically generates URA Payment Registration Numbers (PRNs) for inspection and clearance fees. Once inspection is finalized, the system automatically issues the Import Clearance Certificate (ICC) required before goods exit customs-controlled areas or bonded warehouses (BWIMS).
- **3-Hour Fast-Track Release**: Turnaround time for compliant consignments has been reduced from 3 days to 3 hours. Consignments accompanied by a valid Certificate of Conformity (CoC) under the Pre-Export Verification of Conformity (PVoC) program and, for used motor vehicles, a Certificate of Road Worthiness (CRW), receive unconditional automated release.
- **Automated Inspector Allocation**: Import entries requiring inspection are automatically assigned to UNBS inspectors by the e-Portal to prevent delays and eliminate conflicts of interest.
- **PVoC Evasion Penalty / Surcharge**: Under the UNBS PVoC scheme, regulated imports with a consignment FOB value of USD 2,000 or more must undergo pre-export verification in the country of export. Consignments covered by Compulsory Uganda Standards that bypass PVoC are subjected to Destination Inspection upon arrival and incur a mandatory surcharge of 15% of the CIF (Cost, Insurance, and Freight) value in addition to standard inspection and testing fees.

2. UNBS Legal Notice No. 14 of 2025 & Schedule of Compulsory Uganda Standards (Effective 1 January 2026 / Updated 30 April 2026)

- **Legal Notice No. 14 of 2025**: Issued on 30 June 2025 and effective 1 January 2026, establishing 57 updates to the Schedule of Compulsory Uganda Standards (30 newly declared compulsory standards and 27 revised compulsory standards), bringing total Uganda National Standards to 4,862 standards as of FY 2024/25?FY 2026/27.
- **Schedule of Compulsory Uganda Standards (as of 30 April 2026)**: Enforces mandatory Pre-Export Verification of Conformity (PVoC) and Import Clearance Certificate (ICC) verification across food and agriculture products, electrical and electronic equipment, solar equipment, cosmetics, chemical products, building and construction materials (cement, steel bars, roofing sheets), textiles, used clothing, and motor vehicles.
- **Certificate of Conformity (CoC) Amendment Controls**: Tightened verification controls prohibit unauthorized post-shipment amendments to CoCs prior to ASYCUDA World customs declaration.

3. URA Public Notice on Assent & Effective Date of FY 2026/27 Tax Amendment Acts (Issued 23 September 2026)

Uganda Revenue Authority (URA) notifies taxpayers and the general public that the FY 2026/27 Tax Amendment Acts passed by the 11th Parliament of Uganda were assented to by H.E. the President of the Republic of Uganda with a statutory commencement date of **1 July 2026**:

1. **Income Tax (Amendment) Act, 2026 (Act 21 of 2026)**: Assented 20 August 2026, published in The Uganda Gazette Acts Supplement No. 9 on 28 August 2026, commenced 1 July 2026.
   - Raises the resident individual PAYE tax-free threshold from UGX 2,820,000 per annum (UGX 235,000/month) to **UGX 4,020,000 per annum (UGX 335,000/month)** under Schedule 4 Part I.
   - New resident monthly PAYE bands: 0 to UGX 335,000 (0%); UGX 335,000 to UGX 410,000 (20%); UGX 410,000 to UGX 485,000 (25%); UGX 485,000 to UGX 10,000,000 (30%); above UGX 10,000,000 (40% combined marginal rate).
   - Expands the s.2 definition of "royalty" to include software and excludes royalties from the 5% non-resident Digital Services Tax under s.86(7) so software royalties pay the 15% royalty withholding tax.
   - Imposes 5% withholding tax on interest paid outside Uganda by a resident company in respect of widely issued debentures (s.82 / Schedule 4 Part V).
   - Imposes 15% withholding tax on betting and gaming winnings defined as payout minus amount staked (s.131 / Schedule 4 Part XI), exempting National Lottery and licensed land-based casinos.
   - Imposes 10% withholding tax on commissions paid by telecommunications service providers for airtime, mobile network, and mobile money retail services (s.133 / Schedule 4 Part XIII), and makes the 10% WHT on insurance agent commissions a final tax (s.139).
   - Imposes 6% withholding tax on payments to public entertainers including stage, radio, television, and digital performers (s.135B / Schedule 4 Part XVI) and 6% WHT on purchase of non-business assets (s.130(3) / Schedule 4 Part X).
   - Extends the Bujagali Hydro Power Project income tax exemption to 30 June 2032 and adds Arab Bank for Economic Development in Africa (BADEA) and Uganda Red Cross Society to Schedule 2 exempt listed institutions.

4. Excise Duty, VAT, Tax Procedures Code, Stamp Duty, Lotteries & External Trade Amendments (FY 2026/27, Effective 1 July 2026)

2. **Excise Duty (Amendment) Act, 2026 (Act 22 of 2026)**: Assented 20 August 2026, published 28 August 2026, commenced 1 July 2026.
   - Revises Schedule 2 excise duty rates: Motor spirit (gasoline/petrol) to **UGX 1,750 per litre**; Automotive gas oil (diesel) to **UGX 1,430 per litre**; Cement, adhesives, grout, white cement or lime to **UGX 750 per 50 kg**; Cane or beet sugar to **UGX 200 per kg**; Cooking oil to **UGX 400 per litre**; Cooking fat to **UGX 500 per litre or kg**; Motorcycles at first registration to **UGX 500,000**; Imported un-denatured spirits (<80% ABV) to **80% or UGX 3,500 per litre, whichever is higher**; Local paints/varnishes/lacquers to **3% or UGX 50 per litre/kg** and imported paints/varnishes/lacquers to **10% or UGX 2,000 per litre/kg, whichever is higher**.
3. **Value Added Tax (Amendment) Act, 2026**: Effective 1 July 2026.
   - Doubles the annual VAT registration threshold from UGX 150,000,000 to **UGX 300,000,000** (s.7(2)).
   - Exempts designated VAT withholding agents from withholding 6% VAT where the supplier issues a valid EFRIS e-invoice or e-receipt under s.92 of the Tax Procedures Code Act (s.5(7)).
   - Reduces the qualifying threshold for the **5% VAT refund on EFRIS e-receipts/e-invoices** for non-taxable consumers from UGX 5,000,000 to **UGX 2,000,000** within 30 consecutive days (s.38).
   - Exempts supplies of goods and services to nuclear energy contractors and subcontractors (Schedule 3) and adds BADEA to Schedule 2.
4. **Tax Procedures Code (Amendment) Act, 2026**: Effective 1 July 2026.
   - Reduces the penal tax for failure to use an Electronic Fiscal Device (EFD) or failure to issue an EFRIS e-invoice/e-receipt under s.93(1)-(2) to **double the tax due on the goods or services or 10 currency points (UGX 200,000), whichever is higher**.
   - Reduces the penal tax for possession of unstamped excisable goods under s.21(3) to **double the tax due on the goods or 100 currency points (UGX 2,000,000), whichever is higher**.
   - **Tax Arrears Waivers (s.47C)**: Waives all principal tax, penal tax, and interest outstanding as at **30 June 2016**; and waives any interest and penalty outstanding as at **30 June 2025** where the taxpayer pays the principal tax by **30 June 2027**.
5. **Stamp Duty (Amendment) Act, 2026 (Act 16 of 2026)**: Effective 1 July 2026.
   - Requires financial services providers to file monthly stamp duty returns (subject to 2% simple monthly interest for default) and retain stamp duty records for at least 5 years (s.62(2)).
   - Revises Schedule 2 stamp duty on registration or transfer of a **motorcycle, tricycle, or quadricycle to UGX 30,000** and **any other motor vehicle to UGX 200,000**.
6. **Lotteries and Gaming (Amendment) Act, 2026 (Act 12 of 2026)**: Revises gaming tax rate from 20% to **30% of total money staked less payouts** (Schedule 4).
7. **External Trade (Amendment) Act, 2026**: Exempts imports of vaccines, medicines, medical supplies, pesticides, rodenticides, acaricides, and insecticides from the 1.5% Infrastructure Levy and Import Declaration Fees, and imposes a **30% CIF Environmental Levy** on imported worn clothing and worn articles.

5. URSB Business Registration, Beneficial Ownership & Insolvency Reforms (2024?2026)

- **Companies (Fees) Regulations, 2024**: Name reservation **UGX 35,000**; Registration of company with nominal share capital up to UGX 5,000,000 or company limited by guarantee **UGX 105,000** (above UGX 5,000,000: **1.5% of nominal share capital**); Annual return of private company limited by shares **UGX 55,000**; Annual return of company limited by guarantee **UGX 35,000**; Foreign company annual return **USD 70**; Form 18 / Form 20 / company resolution filing **UGX 35,000**; Company search **UGX 25,000**.
- **Business Names Registration (Amendment) Rules, 2024 (S.I. 2024 No. 43)**: Registration of business name **UGX 55,000**; Name reservation / change of particulars / search / certified copy **UGX 35,000**. Introduces **Rule 8A (Form E ? Annual Statement of Business Continuity)**: every registered business name must file Form E at the end of each calendar year confirming active operation; failure to file for 3 consecutive years triggers removal from the register under s.14(3) of Cap. 109.
- **Companies & Partnership (Beneficial Owner) (Amendment) Regulations, 2024**: Mandates disclosure and maintenance of Beneficial Ownership (BO) registers on the Online Business Registration System (OBRS).